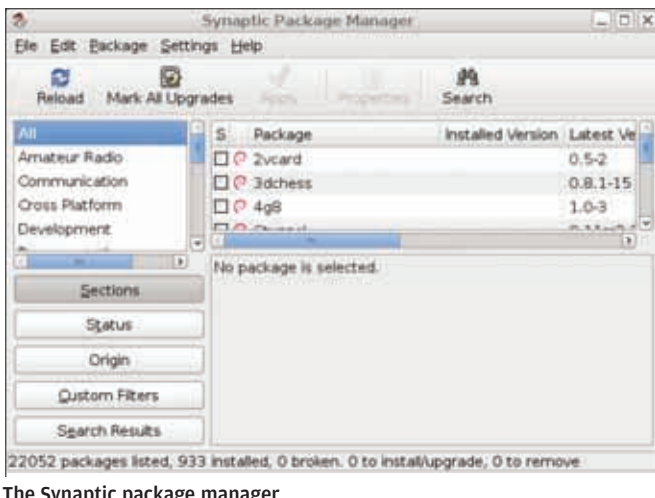




The Synaptic package manager

5.6 Mandriva

Mandriva is a popular distro developed by a company of the same name that has a number of versions for corporate and server use. Mandriva is one of the better looking distros around, and uses the GNOME desktop environment very effectively. Mandriva was earlier known as Mandrake Linux, and originally based on Red Hat. Mandrake Linux was supposed to make Linux easy to use and configure. The second aspect of Mandrake was focused on, which had a detailed control panel which was familiar to what Windows users were used to. The popularity of Mandrake shot up in the early 2000s, and brought with it a legal battle for the company. This was over the name “Mandrake”, which was copyrighted by the Hearst Corporation, who owned the comic book series “Mandrake the Magician”. The name was changed to Mandriva after that. The free edition of Mandriva is to Red Hat what Ubuntu is to Debian, and is still one of the more popular distros around. There are bi-annual releases of Mandriva since 2007, with each release having the year appended to the name instead of the version number. Apart from the yearly releases, there are half-yearly releases, known as the spring editions. The spring editions have a .1 appended to the year name. The latest release of the Operating System is